

VETERANS BACKBONE

DECISION-MAKING & ACCOUNTABILITY FRAMEWORK

(All Roles)

PURPOSE

This framework exists to answer three questions clearly:

- **Who decides what?**
- **How decisions are made safely and fairly**
- **How veterans retain agency in decisions about their own lives**

Clarity prevents confusion.

Shared accountability prevents harm.

CORE PRINCIPLES

At Veterans Backbone:

- Decisions are **proportionate to risk**
 - Authority is **clear, not hierarchical**
 - Accountability works **in all directions**
 - Veterans are **active participants**, not passive recipients
 - Safety overrides preference, but preference matters wherever possible
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VETERAN AGENCY (THIS IS NON-NEGOTIABLE)

Veterans are involved in decisions that affect:

- their support
- their participation
- their goals
- their boundaries

Wherever possible, veterans:

- are consulted
- are listened to
- have choice
- can disagree

Veterans Backbone does **not** make decisions *for* people unless safety requires it.

WHEN VETERANS LEAD DECISIONS

Veterans lead decisions about:

- engagement level
- participation in activities
- personal goals and direction
- pacing and involvement
- feedback on what is or isn't working

Support is collaborative, not directive.

WHEN DECISIONS ARE SHARED

Decisions are shared between veterans and staff when:

- risk is emerging but not immediate
- boundaries need adjusting
- support plans need recalibration
- accountability conversations are needed

These decisions are:

- discussed openly
- explained clearly
- documented appropriately

WHEN VETERANS BACKBONE DECIDES

Veterans Backbone will make decisions without veteran consent **only** when:

- there is a safeguarding risk
- there is risk of harm to self or others
- legal or regulatory duties apply
- boundaries have been repeatedly breached

In these cases:

- decisions are explained
- dignity is maintained
- support remains where possible

Safety overrides autonomy — but never without reason.

DECISION-MAKING AUTHORITY (INTERNAL)

Day-to-Day Decisions

Handled by:

- Calm in the Storm Officers
- Supervisors / Leads

Examples:

- scheduling
 - engagement boundaries
 - routine adjustments
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Operational Decisions

Handled by:

- Chief Organiser of Chaos (*Operations Manager*)

Examples:

- staffing allocation
 - service structure
 - operational risk management
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Safeguarding Decisions

Handled by:

- Chaos Prevention Officer (*Safeguarding Lead*)

Safeguarding decisions override all other considerations.

Strategic & Financial Decisions

Handled by:

- Trustees
- Head of Not Losing Money (*Finance Lead*)
- Senior Leadership

These include:

- funding decisions
 - property decisions
 - organisational direction
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ACCOUNTABILITY (ALL DIRECTIONS)

Staff & Volunteers Are Accountable For:

- their conduct
 - their boundaries
 - raising concerns
 - working within role limits
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Veterans Are Accountable For:

- their behaviour within the space
- respecting others' boundaries
- engaging responsibly where possible

Support does not mean absence of accountability.

Leadership Is Accountable For:

- decisions made
- consequences of those decisions
- listening to feedback
- adjusting when things aren't working

CHALLENGING DECISIONS

Decisions can be challenged:

- respectfully
- openly
- without fear of retaliation

This includes:

- veterans challenging staff decisions
- staff challenging leadership decisions

Challenges are discussed, not punished.

WHEN DECISIONS ARE REVIEWED

Decisions may be reviewed when:

- new information emerges
- circumstances change
- concerns are raised

- outcomes are not as intended

Review is part of responsibility, not weakness.

DOCUMENTATION

Significant decisions will be:

- recorded appropriately
- explained to those affected
- reviewed where necessary

Documentation exists to support clarity, not control.

FINAL WORD

Veterans Backbone is not about control or compliance.

It is about:

- shared responsibility
- informed choice
- clear authority
- human dignity

Veterans are not managed.

They are **respected participants** in their own lives.

Acknowledgement

I understand the decision-making and accountability framework and agree to work within it.

Name:

Role:

Signature:
Date: